

Social Media Performance Report

September 2026

Executive Summary

September was a month of steady growth across all channels. Substack continued to grow its subscriber base while holding a strong 50% average open rate, TikTok kept its highly engaged community, and LinkedIn is now being tracked for the first time with 452 followers.

Instagram is the area to focus on. Views and interactions dropped compared with August, and most of the reach came from existing followers rather than new people. Reels in particular are not getting the views they need. The recommendations for October are designed to fix this without adding a heavy workload, alongside a small, low-risk Meta ads test.

Key Metrics at a Glance

Metric	September	Change vs August	Notes
Instagram Followers	327	+9	Steady, fluctuates
Instagram Views	6,943	-2,827 (-29%)	Reels underperforming
Instagram Interactions	208	-103	Lower reach
Instagram Non-Follower Reach	23.1%	Down from 43.1%	Fewer new people reached
Instagram Profile Visits	166	New metric	Good interest
Instagram Link Taps	5	New metric	Room to improve
Substack Subscribers (total)	113	+10 (from 103)	Consistent growth
Substack Avg. Open Rate	~50%	Stable	Strong engagement
TikTok Followers	55	+7	Highly engaged
TikTok Engagement	Very High	Stable	Comments and questions
LinkedIn Followers	452	First month tracked	New baseline

Note: Substack no longer shows the paid/unpaid split, so this month reports total subscribers only.

Platform Deep Dives

Instagram

Needs Attention

Total Followers: 327 (up 9)

Total Views: 6,943 (down from 9,770)

Total Interactions: 208 (down from 311)

Audience: 76.9% Followers / 23.1% Non-Followers

Profile Visits: 166

External Link Taps: 5

Follower numbers are still growing, but views and interactions are down. The biggest change is in who is seeing the content: non-followers dropped from 43.1% to 23.1% of the audience. This means posts are mostly reaching people who already follow, and Instagram is not pushing the content out to new audiences. Reels are the main reason, as they are the format Instagram uses most to reach non-followers.

166 profile visits is a good sign that people are curious, but only 5 of those tapped the link. Making the link in bio clearer (for example, one simple link pointing to the Substack with a short line explaining why to subscribe) could turn more of those visits into readers.

Substack

Your Revenue Engine

Total Subscribers: 113 (up 10)

Average Open Rate: ~50%

Substack continues to grow at a steady pace, and a 50% open rate for a second month shows readers are consistently opening and reading the essays. This remains the main conversion hub. Discovery call bookings from the essay links are still to be confirmed, and tracking these in October will show which topics are turning readers into clients.

TikTok

Strongest Engagement

Followers: 55 (up 7)

Engagement: Very High

TikTok is still the most engaged platform. People regularly comment and ask questions, which shows the content is starting real conversations. Follower growth was slower than August, but the quality of engagement is excellent. These questions are also a ready-made source of content ideas.

LinkedIn

New Baseline

Followers: 452

LinkedIn has the largest follower count of any platform. This is the first month it has been tracked, so 452 becomes the starting point to measure growth from. With an audience this size, it is worth continuing to test question-led carousel captions to encourage more conversation.

October Focus Areas

1. Stronger Hooks on Reels

Keep opening every Reel with a hook in the very first line you say. Add the same hook as bold on-screen text in the first second, as many people scroll with the sound off. This is the quickest fix for low Reel views.

2. Launch an Advice Series

Start a named, numbered series (for example, "Advice Part 1, Part 2..."). Series give people a reason to follow and come back for the next one. The questions people ask on TikTok can be used as topics.

3. Add B-Roll to Reels

Use simple B-roll such as writing at your desk, walking, coffee or everyday moments. It adds movement and keeps viewers watching longer, without needing extra talking-to-camera filming.

4. Continue Polls

Keep running polls on Substack Notes and Instagram Stories. They are quick to make, build interaction and show what topics the audience wants more of.

5. Quotes on Substack Notes and as Images

Take the strongest line from each essay and share it as a Substack Note and as a quote graphic on Instagram. This reuses writing you have already done and keeps the visual style consistent.

6. Reuse TikTok Winners on Instagram

When a TikTok gets strong comments, post the same video as an Instagram Reel with captions. It is a low-effort way to get proven content in front of the Instagram audience.

7. Track Discovery Calls

Check how many calls are booked from each essay link. This shows which topics convert best and should guide what you write next.

Suggested Meta Ads Test (Instagram)

A small, low-risk test run on Instagram only, to reach new people and grow the Substack. Keeping it to one platform makes the results easier to read. The idea is to learn what works before spending more.

What	Suggestion
Platform	Instagram only (set placements to Instagram Feed, Stories and Reels, and turn off Facebook)
Budget	\$5 per day for 14 days (about \$70 total)
What to promote	1 to 2 posts that already perform well organically (a Reel or carousel), not new content
Goal	Traffic to the free Substack subscribe page (easier first step than booking a call)
Audience	People similar to your current followers, plus people who have engaged with your Instagram
What to measure	Cost per new Substack subscriber and total new subscribers during the test
Next step if it works	Increase to around \$100 to \$150 per month, and add a retargeting ad pointing to the discovery call

Tip: Boosting a post that already has good engagement usually costs less per result than a brand-new ad, because the content is already proven.

The Takeaway

The foundation is strong. Substack is growing, readers are opening the essays, and TikTok has a community that actively engages and asks questions. LinkedIn also gives a larger audience to build on.

October is about getting Instagram reaching new people again through stronger Reels, and testing whether a small Meta ads budget can speed up Substack growth. Keep tracking discovery calls so we can see which content is turning readers into clients.

Thanks,
Jessa